

Guidelines for Research Proposal Writing

The objective of the research component is to develop knowledge and skills of the undergraduate to plan and conduct a research project using scientific methods, analyze data using basic statistical methods, derive appropriate conclusions and recommendations and to present the findings in a scientific report within the time frame available.

The following guidelines are issued with regard to formulating the research proposal:

A. General

The main research project should be based on “quantitative research” and the data should be “primary data”. The mini-project can either be quantitative or qualitative in design and can involve secondary data as well. The trainee should personally be involved with data collection.

B. Proposal writing

The proposal should be written in third person/passive voice future tense.

1. Title -

It should be short and accurate and should reflect on the main theme of the research carried out.

2. Introduction: Should consists of three main components:

- a. **Background information:** may include subheadings under this as per relevance to the description of the research problems. All relevant literature to be included under this section.
- b. **Justification**
- c. **Objectives:** General objective and Specific objectives

3. Methods - Should include details regarding the following in the given sequence:

- a. Study type/design
- b. Study setting
- c. Study period
- d. Study population/s with Inclusion / Exclusion criteria according to relevance
- e. Calculation of sample size –
- f. Sampling technique
- g. Intervention – describe briefly the proposed intervention (applicable only to an intervention study) and clear statement of outcomes
- h. Study instruments

- i. Questionnaire – type of the questionnaire and broad components to be briefly described
- ii. Other data collection tools - broad components to be briefly described
- i. Study implementation/ Plan for data collection – a brief account including pre testing
- j. Data analysis – A brief account of data processing, software and statistical methods (descriptive and inferential statistics) applicable to each specific objective.
- k. Administrative requirements
- l. Ethical issues and clearance
- m. Definitions of variables specific to the study (excluding socio demographic variables) defined in operational terms.

4. References - Should use the Harvard System, American Psychological Association Style (APA).

5. Budget - To be included as an Annex (a sample budget is included below). Should be developed separately for the mini-project and the major component.

Items Estimated	Cost
Stationery	
Travel	
Printing	
Consumables	
Miscellaneous	
Total	

6. Time frame - Gantt chart. To be included as an Annex. (a sample Gantt chart is included below). Should be developed separately for the mini-project and the major component.

Activity	Nov. 2016	Dec. 2016	Jan. 2017	Feb. 2017	March 2017
Literature survey					
Proposal writing					
Ethics clearance					
Planning data collection					
Data collection					
Data entry					
Data analysis					
Report writing					

C. Formatting instructions

The proposal should be word-processed and printed on both sides of A4-size paper.

Margins - 1 inch / 2.5 cm on all four sides

Font Style - Times New Roman

Font Size - 12

Line Spacing -1.15

Proposed Supervisor - Name to be included

Number of Pages - Not exceeding six (6) pages excluding Annexes

Number of Copies - Three (3)

D. Date of Submission

The date of submission shall be as specified by the Academic Department, MSU.